Ryan Cruz

Senior Cybersecurity Engineer · Identity & Access Management

Dallas, Texas

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Summary

Senior Cybersecurity Engineer with 8+ years at Southwest Airlines building and running identity platforms at airline scale. Led the move of 70,000+ employees to a modern identity provider with SSO and MFA, and launched customer identity for 100M+ Southwest.com members. Hands-on across federation (SAML, OIDC, SCIM), privileged access, and cloud infrastructure as code, with a focus on making secure sign-in invisible to users.

Experience

Southwest Airlines — *Dallas, Texas*

Senior Cybersecurity Engineer - Customer IAM — *October 2022 - Present*

- Created a customer identity platform for 100M+ Southwest.com and Rapid Rewards members from the ground up, reducing fraud, increasing security, and improving the customer experience.

Cybersecurity Engineer - Workforce IAM — *May 2021 - October 2022*

- Migrated 70,000+ employees to a modern IdP, delivering SSO and MFA across hundreds of applications.

Associate Cybersecurity Engineer - Cybersecurity Operations — *August 2018 - May 2021*

- Resolved requests and incidents across Southwest's security tooling, including CyberArk, AD, F5, and more

Apple — *Athens, Georgia*

Mac+ Technical Advisor — *September 2016 - May 2018*

- Supported iOS, watchOS, and macOS customers, including identity and access issues with Apple ID and iCloud accounts.

Equifax — *Alpharetta, Georgia*

IT Asset Management Intern — *August 2017 - May 2018*

- Led a University of Georgia capstone team that taught Equifax's software catalog to classify unrecognized software on company assets.

Projects

Marten — *martenldap.com*

Native macOS LDAP browser on the Mac App Store — *March 2026 - Present*

- Built a native macOS app in Swift and SwiftUI to browse, search, and edit LDAP and PingDirectory REST directories.
- Wrote the LDAPv3 client on SwiftNIO with bounded BER parsing, fail-closed TLS, and OAuth 2.0 with PKCE.
- Added previewed, read-only search generation with Apple Intelligence that sends only request text, with consent.

Skills

Identity & Access	Ping Identity, Active Directory, CyberArk, SAML, OAuth 2.0 / OIDC, SCIM, MFA, Passkeys / FIDO2
Security	IAM governance, privileged access management, Zero Trust architecture, identity lifecycle
Cloud & DevOps	AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform, Git, CI/CD
Programming	Go, Swift, Python, Java, JavaScript, Bash, SQL

Education

University of Georgia — *Athens, Georgia*

B.S. in Computer Systems Engineering — *August 2014 - May 2018*

- Zell Miller Scholarship
- Presidential Scholar
- Certificate: Emerging Engineering Leaders Development Program